

Arun Avanathan

SUMMARY

Has a proven track record of architecting & building large scale cloud-based services. Leader wearing multiple hats, Hands on Architect, Innovator, Mentor with a clear focus on customer value to name a few. Pragmatic to master how to use short vs long and when to use two way vs one way solutions. Consistently seen results in better application performance, engineering velocity, constantly pushing boundaries to get the best out of the System.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Scaled QuickBooks platform with a global team of ~400 developers & 60+ teams
- Shaped the architecture of distributed software applications for 14+ years
- Driven multiple complex & long projects (3+ years) to Production closely working with cross functional teams.
- Improved availability of QuickBooks Platform from 3 to 4 nines using loosely coupled architecture.
- Crafting distributed APIs & software applications in cloud environments for 10+ years serving billions of requests a day
- Consistently coaching engineering teams for 15+ years to get them from good to great
- In the last 10+ years, successfully guided teams to transition from monolith to microservices for 3+ large-scale applications to improve time to market & reducing tech debt.
- Launched AI community for Java (Spring AI for GenAI), Deeplearning4J, Tribuo for conventional AI.
- Lead Architect for Identity Domain for Small Business Group for the last 4+ years.
- Proactively look out for better engineering solutions and guide the teams onboard if beneficial.
- Constantly look for opportunities to challenge the status quo.

SKILLS

Application Performance Tuning • AWS • Enterprise Architecture • RESTful Microservices • Large Scale Distributed Applications • Java • Spring Boot • AuthN/AuthZ • Identity Services • Spring AI, Deeplearning4j & Tribuo • Influence without authority • Driving Innovation • Strategic Pathfinder • Leadership with a vision

EXPERIENCE

Principal SW Engineer, Mailchimp

Dec 2024 - PRESENT

Currently Leading:

- Engineering for Mailchimp Marketing influencing over 300+ engineers (core team of 50+ eng). Architecting & collaborating with cross domain teams (Product, GTM, Security, AI & Legal). My primary responsibilities include - (a) Building Analytical pipeline to build the Context for AI Agents, Personalization & to improve the customer funnel. (b) Building An AI Agent to guide customers to choose the right Mailchimp product flavor for their use case.

- Engineering for Mailchimp Identity Team (Core 12+ eng). Here, I'm working on replatforming Mailchimp Identity to use Intuit Identity as the primary Identity Provider. The scope & impact for this initiative is ~700 engineers

Principal SW Engineer, Intuit

Nov 2020 - Nov 2024

QuickBooks Online (QBO) is a large scale SaaS application serving millions of small business users with billion+ api requests per day. This involves working closely with 400+ engineers across the Small Business Org. The Identity component functions as a cross cutting layer within the application, guaranteeing product security and compliance.

- Modernizing QBO platform to enhance customer experience, while prioritizing security and availability.
- Collaborating with central identity, security & cross functional teams towards the common goal
- Enabling & mentoring team members to achieve their goals
- Influencing a team of ~180 engineers to use AuthZ in a consistent way towards target state
- Reduced service level dependencies(by 60%) for QuickBooks online
- Used aggressive caching & creative solutions to reduce the number of decisions from 5B to 300M.
- Built authorization layers using Open Policy Agent (OPA) for granular permissions
- Working with cross domain PE/Architects on Standards & RFCs
- Laying out tech strategy to improve Application Performance (web,api & mobile) with Systematic improvements to process, tools & patterns.

Principal SW Engineer, Intuit

Feb 2019 - Oct 2020

Intuit encourages employees to spin up products under incubation. In this program, we found a startup - **FormFly** - A SaaS platform for Tax Information Filing.

- Led high performing & autonomous Engineering Team
- Worked with cross functional groups to launch an API platform for form 1099.
- Designed an event driven architecture for RESTful APIs - using DynamoDB Streams to handle millions of API requests per day.
- Built event based performance testing suite in AWS using Lambda & generate reports
- Shared a 6 pager with SLT on the churns & blockers team went through to make this happen.

Principal SW Engineer, Intuit

May 2018 - Feb 2019

Built and maintained Contractor invitation system between **QuickBooks Online** & **QuickBooks Self Employed** products. An ability for Small Business owners to invite vendors/contractors for sharing 1099 Documents, Direct Deposits & to manage W4 forms. This is a small scale but complex infrastructure dealing with a few thousand events per day.

Principal SW Engineer/Architect, Intuit

Oct 2014 - Apr 2018

Defined Target State Architecture for **Intuit Developer Portal** and **Intuit App Store**.

- Decomposing the monolith from internal data centers into highly available micro services in AWS (Spring Boot, MySQL RDS, ElastiCache, ActiveMQ, S3, Lambda and EC2).

- Scaling AppConnect - Migrated this large application to AWS to make it highly scalable & available. Improved application performance using several strategies - Eg. partitioning log tables, migration to DynamoDB

Principal SW Engineer, Intuit

Jan 2014 - Sep 2014

Drove the initiative - break the monolith - for **QuickBooks Payroll**.

- Decomposed a logical slice of the application into RESTful service - a pattern for the team to continue. This was done using Java, Spring Boot & MySQL
- Built a foundational framework layer to allow teams to use consistent patterns for building micro services.

Staff Engineer, Intuit

Aug 2011 - Dec 2013

At **Intuit Partner Platform** - third party developer platform for QuickBooks - I was the core contributor for building APIs for QuickBooks Desktop in the Cloud. This enabled 3rd party developers to build applications for QuickBooks Desktop customers.

Principal SW Engineer, NexTag

Jan 2010 - Aug 2011

- Core contributor of Nextag Stores redesign for PCI Compliance. At this time my contribution was mainly around getting ready for PCI Level 2 Compliance.
- Built backend services using Spring, MySQL for Inventory Management System

Director of Technology, StyleHive

Dec 2007 - Dec 2009

- Built the social networking site for the reads top of MySQL DB (WordPress Schema).
- Writes are done via JMS messaging infrastructure.
- Content writers use Wordpress admin tools to write content.
- Think of this as an early version of Pinterest for Fashion enthusiasts.

Software Development Manager, eBay

Sep 2005 - Jun 2007

As a consultant, managed a team of 10 working with Product, Quality & Customer care teams

- Dynamic sales for eBay Stores Items using messaging infrastructure. This used proprietary messaging infrastructure to provide discounts to store items on a schedule. Learnt about distributed locking & how to use Oracle as a non-relational DB(no joins)
- Multi Factor Authentication with a third party service for eBay Trust & Safety

Software Engineer, Wipro & MindTree

Oct 1996 - Nov 2007

As a consultant worked for multiple clients such as Allied Signal, Franklin Templeton, GE & Schlumberger to name a few. Can provide more details as needed

EDUCATION

University of Mysore, India — Masters of Computer Applications, 1993 - 1996

University of Mysore, India — Bachelors of Mathematics & Physics, 1989 - 1993